

Summer 2025

Timeline: May 12th- August 25th

June 23rd- July 11th: Out of the country

Completed Character Creator (Functionality)

The character creator should be fully functional on a systems level. The player should be able to customize their character's face, body, and personal data. Completing the character creator by the end of summer will ensure that we can focus on asset creation and implementation in the fall.

- ART: Character model
 - Concept Art- Character Model
 - Should include tallest, shortest, fattest, and thinnest parameters
 - Should include four options for head shapes
 - 3D Modeling- Character Model
 - A unisex model for character creation
 - Should be able to be dynamically altered using the system Aidan designed
 - No clipping of limbs into body
 - Animation- Character Model
 - Creation of an animation rig for the character model
 - Idle animation
 - Wave animation
 - Documentation explaining the process of implementing animations into the game for Undergraduate students in the fall
- PROGRAMMING: Character Creator Second Pass
 - 'Features' System
 - When designing the face, players can edit the characters eyes, eyebrows, nose, mouth, and a general 'misc' tab.
 - This will be used for simple animations during the game. Eyes can blink, eyebrows can raise, the mouth can open and shut
 - It will be important to focus on making this system not feel overly complicated
 - 'Base' Hair vs 'Add-On' Hair
 - Hair should have the player select one base, then be able to add on extras
 - Sort assets as either a base or an add on
 - Up-Do base, pony tail add-on
 - 'Expressions' System

- Find a way to edit the facial layers to animate the face
 - Wide-Eye sprite for shock, open mouth sprite for talking, rotate eyebrows for anger, ect.
- ‘Take a Picture’ System
 - At the end of character creation, the game takes a picture of the character’s bust and saves it as an icon
 - 2-D representation of the character for character selection menus
 - Can explore 3-D character selection but that seems painful and evil
- AUDIO: Character Creation Audio
 - Character Creator Theme
 - A catchy but not overly distracting tune for the character creation menu
 - Button/ Slider SFX
 - Mess around with different SFX for clicking on tabs, buttons, and moving sliders
- UI: Character Creation UI
 - Playtesting and Iteration
 - The character creator will go through playtests and the UI will be tweaked and altered in response to the player feedback

Finish Town Sim Prototype

Add the remaining features to the town sim prototype for playtesting in the fall.

- PROGRAMMING: Town Sim Narrative System
 - Cutscene Manager
 - Design a system that allows character interactions
 - Should change camera, camera focus, dialogue box, character expressions, possibly background tracks
- PROGRAMMING: Basic Character Interactions
 - Friendship Event
 - Conversation in the park where the player can raise, maintain, or decrease two characters’ relationships
 - Fight Event
 - Problem where two characters can get into an argument and the player can choose how to handle it

Stretch Goals!

- ‘Features’ System addition: Expression editing
 - Player’s will be able to edit their character’s expressions individually (happy, sad, surprised, sleeping, winking)

- Extra animations
 - Dance animation
 - Twirl animation
- Character creator theme variations
 - Small instrumentation changes in the facial editor, body editor, and player info editor
- Saving System
 - Saves player data not using Playerprefs
 - Created characters can be saved, stored, brought up between sessions
- Fun animations in Park scene
 - 'Point-and-Click' type animations for the different props in the park scene
 - Clicking the BBQ makes it fire up, clicking trees makes them shake, clicking the fountain makes it spray water, ect

Fall Semester 2025

Timeline: August 25th- December 13th

Completed Character Creator (Assets)

With the help of undergrads, implement both 2D and 3D models to give the character creator plenty of options.

- Art- 2D
 - Concept Art
 - Facial Features
 - Hair bases
 - Hair accessories
 - Clothing options
 - Facial Assets
 - High-resolution features from concept art
- Art- 3D
 - Hair Assets
 - Hair bases from concept art
 - Hair accessories from concept art
 - Clothing Assets
 - Clothing assets from concept art
 - Clipping tests for created clothing assets
- Programming
 - Character Creator Iteration
 - Further playtesting on character creation, implementing changes and modifications in response to feedback
 - Saving System
 - Saves player data not using PlayerPrefs
 - Created characters can be saved, stored, brought up between sessions
 - Add information to the CharacterData class to store the customizations
 - Town Sim Characters
 - Ability to call and load character models in the town sim
 - Created characters will get a house in the town and are able to be visited and viewed
 - Simple dialogue exchange and animation
 - Ability to change character's clothes through gifting items

Spring Semester 2025

Timeline: January 1st- May 1st

March 9th: GDC

Lock in the Character Creator

If there are any remaining character creator tasks, they will take priority over the town sim until completion.

- All Departments
 - Character Creator Finalization
 - Ironing out any remaining bugs and issues in the Character Creator
 - Should be completed before moving on to Town Sim side of the game

Town Sim Development

- Art- 2D
 - Environmental concept art
 - Explore designs for the various environments of the Town Sim
 - Additional Clothing concept art
- Art- Character 3D
 - Additional clothing assets
 - Expand the available options for clothing in the Town Sim
- Art- Environment 3D
 - Character Houses
 - Start with one 'basic' house and expand to three if there is time
 - Best Friend Quest Environment
 - Port with a boat prop that the characters hop onto
 - Animation of the two characters on the boat going through the water
 - Small island and collection animation
 - Restaurant
 - Kitchen environment for the cooking minigame
 - Props for the characters to hold
- Writing- Character Interactions
 - Problems
 - Five problem scenarios with quirky dialogue and a few fail case dialogues
 - Vignettes
 - Three character interactions
 - Fight, Party, and Park scene